UU-T-1331A
June 10, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. UU-T-1331
January 22, 1973

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TAPE, POSTAGE METER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers gummed and pressure sensitive postage meter tape (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Tapes shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I. Tape, Gummed

Class 1. Item 29-C
Class 2. Item 29-D

Type II. Tape, Pressure Sensitive

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-C-128 - Card, Index
UU-P-121 - Paper, Bond & Writing, White & Colored
UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping
PPP-B-26 - Bag, Plastic, Polyethylene
PPP-B-1055 - Barrier Material, Waterproofed, Flexible
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard, Corrugated & Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced & Plan, For Sealing & Securing
PPP-T-680 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive, Packaging & Packing
PPP-T-681 - Tape, Gummed, Packaging & Packing Of

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Methods:

T 401 - Fiber Analysis of Paper and Paperboard.
T 402 - Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets and Related Products.
T 404 - Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.
T 410 - Weight per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Paper.

3.1.1 Stock. The paper used in fabricating the tape shall be woven kraft, free from unbleached or ground wood pulp. The paper must be suitable for coating on one side with adhesive that will not migrate through to the printing surface and be capable of absorbing meter ink on the printing side with a minimum of smearing.

3.1.2 Color. The color shall be white or very light pastel color.

3.1.3 Basis weight.

3.1.3.1 Type I. The basis weight of the ungummed paper shall be 56 pounds ± 5% (25 x 38-500).

3.1.3.2 Type II. The basis weight of the paper without adhesive shall be 50 pounds ± 5% (25 x 38-500).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2 Tape.

3.2.1 Overall design. No overall design is required. However, tape with a design is acceptable provided the design is open to provide sufficient clear surface to absorb meter stamp ink, and the design, color and type of ink impression are so subdued that all parts of a meter stamp impression are readily legible. Ink used in printing the design shall not cause blocking or delay drying of postage meter ink. Proposed designs shall be submitted for approval to the contracting officer.

3.2.2 Adhesion. When the adhesive is properly moistened with water, the gummed tape must readily and firmly adhere to the types of surfaces commonly used as mailing containers (see 4.4.2). Pressure sensitive adhesive shall require no heat, moisture, or other preparation prior to application. The tape should adhere and not strip from the test surfaces without fiber separation.

3.2.3 Warning signal. Both roll edges shall show a red signal stripe of approximately three feet, starting within three feet of the end of the tape and extending to the core. The warning signal shall be a continuous or broken red stripe of such width as to provide at least one inch clear tape, so that the meter stamp impression will be clear and legible.

3.2.4 Type I.

3.2.4.1 Adhesive. Adhesive shall not absorb moisture from an atmosphere of 90% relative humidity sufficient for it to stick in the tape track of the machine or block in the roll (see 4.4.1).

3.2.4.2 Thickness. Paper shall be sufficiently uniform in thickness to provide rolls of tape of the lengths and diameters specified in Table I.

3.2.4.3 Edges. Edges shall be either straight or serrated.

3.2.5 Type II.

3.2.5.1 Construction. Tape shall be of two-ply paper construction. The printing paper shall have one surface capable of being printed on with postage meter ink and the other side coated with a pressure sensitive adhesive. The release liner shall be designed to carry and protect the printing paper while being fed through a postage meter and to separate the upper ply.

3.2.5.2 Release liner.

3.2.5.2.1 Stock. The release liner shall be a silicone coated paper. The paper shall be woven kraft, free from unbleached or ground wood pulp.

3.2.5.2.2 Basis weight. The basis weight of the paper without silicone coating shall be 44 pounds ± 5% (25 x 38-500).

3.2.5.2.3 Dimensions. The release liner, with width of 1 5/16 + 0, - 1/64, shall be made in accordance with figure 1. The 1 3/32 inch wide printing paper shall be mounted with a 1/32 inch clearance on one side and 3/16 inch on the other. On the 3/16 inch side, there are feed holes of size, 3/16 inch in length with a 3/64 inch radius spaced 2 1/4 inches center to center at the perforations.

3.2.5.3 Adhesive.

3.2.5.3.1 Application. Adhesive shall be applied to the 1 3/32" printing paper strip so that two 3/16" strips or voids free of adhesive are located 1/8" ± 1/64" from each edge of the strip (see Figure 1).

3.2.5.3.2 Ink resistance. Adhesive shall resist penetration of postage meter ink, which may bleed through the printing paper strip.

3.2.5.3.3 Flow or bleed. Adhesive shall not flow or bleed under conditions of storage (see 3.5.2.2) or usage (see 3.5.2.3) to a degree that would cause either blocking of rolls, separation of the paper layers, or adhesive pick-up by the postage meter feeding mechanism.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.5.4 Printing paper.

3.2.5.4.1 Perforations. The strip shall be perforated at intervals of 2 1/4", such that the individual, perforated pieces of tape between perforations have a minimum tensile strength of 1.2 kg/15mm. width ± 0.8 kg/15mm. width. The area that is unperforated at manufacture and torn after printing shall not have fibers trailing from the edges greater than 1/32".

3.2.5.4.2 Release liner adhesion. The silicone treated liner shall be such that the printing paper is easily peelable from the release liner. It shall adhere to the release liner without separation while being fed through the postage meter.

3.2.5.5 Tape. Tape shall be constructed in accordance with Figure 1.

3.3 Rolls.

3.3.1 Type I.

3.3.1.1 Dimensions. The length, width and diameter of rolls of tape shall be as specified in Table I.

TABLE I. Roll Dimensions

	Minimum Length In Feet	Outside Maximum Diameter In Inches	Width In Inches
Type I			
Class 1	265'	5"	1 5/16" ± 1/32"
Class 2	65'	2 1/2"	1 5/16" ± 1/32"
Type II	(see 3.3.2.1)	6 3/32"	1 5/16" + 0,-1/64"

3.3.1.2 Roll construction. Tape shall not be fastened to the core and shall be of one continuous piece with no splices or patches. All rolls shall be free from paper dust and lint and shall be wound with the gummed side out, except that Class 2 shall be wound with the gummed side in. The core shall be held firmly in place in the roll. The tape shall be processed through gum breakers to cause the paper to lie flat.

3.3.2 Type II.

3.3.2.1 Dimensions. The outside diameter and width of the rolls shall be in accordance with Table I. The roll shall contain not less than 1,500 individual 2 1/4" lengths of tape. The tape roll leader shall be a minimum length of 31 1/2".

3.3.2.2 Roll construction. The adhesive coated printing paper and release liner comprising the tape shall be wound on a core to form the tape roll. Edges of the tape roll shall be straight. Tape shall be wound on the core in one continuous piece with no splices or patches with uniform tension and with the printing surface of the printing paper inside on the roll. The perforations shall neither separate nor buckle when wound on the core. The force necessary to separate the tapes from the core shall not exceed 0.2 kg. The core shall be held firmly in place in the roll.

3.4 Cores. Cores shall be of a uniform finish and may be embossed on the side with the postage meter identification number.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.1 Type I. Cores shall conform to the dimensions specified in Table II.

TABLE II. Core Dimensions

	Width	Outside Diameter	Hole Diameter
Type I			
Class 1	1 5/16" + 0, - 1/32"	2"	19/32" ± 1/64"
Class 2	1 5/16" + 0, - 1/32"	1"	1/2" + 1/64", - 0
Type II	1 5/16" + 0, - 1/64"	1 3/4"	.690" with 8 splines

3.4.2 Type II. Cores shall conform to Figure 2, and dimensions as specified in table II.

3.5 Physical properties.

3.5.1 Ink penetration. Ink penetration of the side without adhesive shall be 50 seconds maximum as ascertained by subjecting samples to the test specified in 4.4.3.

3.5.2 Environmental conditions.

3.5.2.1 Shelf life. Tape rolls shall have a minimum shelf life of 18 months from the date of pack (see 5.3) and shall pass any examination or test specified herein provided that they are packaged and stored as specified herein.

3.5.2.2 Storage. Tape rolls shall be capable of being stored continuously at temperatures from 0°F to 100°F with relative humidities from 10% to 90%.

3.5.2.3 Usage. Tape shall be capable of being used at the same temperatures and humidities at which it is stored (see 4.4.2).

3.5.3 Type I.

3.5.3.1 Blocking. There shall be no blocking of tape when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.5.3.2 Tensile strength. The average tensile strength of the paper with adhesive shall not be less than 8.0 kg/15mm. width when tested as specified in Table III.

3.5.4 Type II.

3.5.4.1 Blocking. The release liner shall prevent blocking when subjected to temperatures from -20°F to 140°F at 10% to 90% relative humidity (see 4.4.1.2).

3.5.4.2 Tensile strength.

3.5.4.2.1 Printing paper. The tensile strength of the unperforated printing paper tape shall be a minimum of 4 kg/15mm. width when tested as specified in Table III.

3.5.4.2.2 Release liner. The tensile strength of the release liner shall be a minimum of 4.3 kg/15mm. width when tested as specified in Table III.

3.5.4.3 Usage. The printing paper strip shall be so constructed that when printing postage on the tape strip in a Pitney-Bowes, Model 5850 postage meter, or equivalent, with a new ink roller, which has been used for a minimum of 100 imprints, any edge of the postage imprint shall show not more than 0.10 variation from the straight edges of the imprint.

3.6 Workmanship. Tape shall be clean and free from folds, sharp creases, tears, cuts and holes. The adhesive coating shall cover the entire specified area of the side to which it is applied. The tape shall be clearly cut without nicks or ragged edges and shall conform to the levels of quality established herein.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all rolls of tape of the same type and class submitted for inspection at one time.

4.1.2 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications and standards.

4.1.2.1 Components testing. Each lot of paper in the fabrication of the paper rolls shall be tested in accordance with the applicable test methods specified hereinafter, to determine compliance with the requirements of section 3. Each inspection lot shall consist of a component of a single type or grade manufactured by the same source, under essentially the same conditions and used in the production of the quantity of the end item submitted for inspection at one time.

4.1.2.2 Evidence of compliance. In lieu of using his own facilities, the contractor may submit a report of analysis of component materials from a laboratory acceptable to the Government, whether an independent test facility or the laboratory of the raw material supplier, as evidence of compliance with the specification requirements. The report of analysis shall include, in addition to the actual test data, the manufacturer's name, name and address of the testing laboratory, date of test, and quantity of material represented by the test report. Where certificates of compliance or reports of analysis are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certificate or analysis.

4.2 Testing of components.

4.2.1 Paper. Component materials shall be tested for the applicable characteristics specified in table III. The test shall be made in accordance with the indicated TAPPI methods or as referenced in the table. The lot size for the purpose of determining the sample size shall be expressed in pounds of paper used in the manufacture of the paper rolls. The sample size shall consist of not less than 2,000 square inches of base paper. The sample size shall be drawn in accordance with level S-1 of MIL-STD-105. Test results shall include all values upon which the results are based and there shall be no failures to meet the composite, or lot average requirements. The composite sample shall consist of approximately equal amounts drawn from all sample units combined into a single sample. Except where otherwise specified, all samples shall be conditioned and tested under uniform atmospheric conditions as specified in TAPPI method T 402.

TABLE III. Instructions for testing of components.

Characteristic	Specification reference: Requirements	Specification reference: Test method	Requirements applicable to Lot avg.	Number determinations per unit	Results reported Numerically to nearest
Atmospheric conditions	4.2.1	T 402	All testing		
Paper					
Paper fiber content	3.1.1	T 401	Composite	2 per composite	5 percent
Basis weight	3.1.3	T 410	X	one	1 pound
Tensile strength	3.5.3.2 3.5.4.2	T 404	X	ten	0.1 Kilogram

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.3.1 Sampling. Samples of shipping containers, packages and rolls of tape shall be examined for the defects set forth in the applicable subparagraphs. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be as indicated below.

Examination paragraph	Lot size units	Inspection level	AQL defects per hundred units
4.3.1.1	Shipping containers	S-2	2.5
4.3.1.2	Packages 1/	S-3	4.0
4.3.1.3	Tape Rolls 1/	S-3	2.5

1/ Packages and rolls sampled shall be from the shipping containers selected for examination in 4.3.1.1.

4.3.1.1 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table below. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time.

Examination	Defects
Containers	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of containers. Cushioning inadequate, improper or missing.

4.3.1.2 Package. The sample unit for this examination shall be one package of tape rolls. Approximately an equal number of packages shall be selected from the shipping containers selected under 4.3.1.1. Examination shall be in accordance with PPP-T-680 or PPP-T-681, as applicable.

4.3.1.3 Examination of the end item. The sample unit shall be one roll of tape and not more than two sample units shall be selected from any package.

Examination	Defects
Paper	Unable to cut or tear freely due to long fibers. Adhesive migrates through to the printing side. Color not white or light pastel color.
Tape	Not type or class specified. Overall design precludes legibility of meter impression. Warning signal not as specified in 3.2.3. Type I. Roll not of the specified minimum length (see Table I). Width is not in conformance with Table I. Edges not as specified. Type II. Not properly constructed. Adhesive not properly applied (see 3.2.5.3.1).
Rolls	Dimensions not as specified in Table I. Rolls not constructed as specified (see 3.3.1.2 or 3.3.2.2).
Cores	Do not conform to Table II or Figure 2, as applicable.
Workmanship	Not clean; has folds, sharp creases, tears, cuts, holes, nicks, or ragged edges.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Testing of the end item. The paper tape shall be tested for performance and the physical properties specified in section 3, for each lot submitted for inspection at one time. The sample unit for these tests shall consist of six rolls from one package. Five sample units randomly selected from the shipping containers selected under 4.2.1.1 shall be tested. If any roll of tape fails the tests as specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.2, and 4.4.3, the lot shall be rejected.

4.4.1 Blocking.

4.4.1.1 Type I. Rolls of tape shall be conditioned in 90% ± 2% relative humidity at 120°F for 24 hours. Then condition the rolls in accordance with TAPPI T-402 for a minimum of 4 hours. Next, the rolls of tape shall be installed in a postage meter (see 6.1.1)and the entire length run through the meter. Blocking of the tape to itself sufficient to remove fibers or material from the backing of the adjacent strip or delamination of the tape or sticking of the tape to the tape track of the machine shall constitute failure.

4.4.1.2 Type II. Rolls of tape shall be conditioned in 75% ± 2% relative humidity at 140°F for 24 hours. Immediately after removal from the test atmosphere the rolls of tape shall be installed in a Pitney-Bowes, Model 5850 postage meter, or equivalent, and the entire length run through the meter. Blocking of the tape to the release liner sufficient to remove fibers or material from the liner or delamination of the tape by sticking of the tape to the tape track of the machine shall constitute failure.

4.4.2 Adhesion. Test strips of tape shall be applied at temperatures of 40°F and 100°F ± 2°F to the following materials. Both the tape and material shall be conditioned for 24 hours in relative humidities of 10% and 90% at temperatures of 40°F and 100°F, respectively. Materials designated under f, g and h apply only to Type II tapes, whereas a, b, c, d, and e applies to both Types I and II.

a. Bond paper conforming to UU-P-121, Type I.
b. Kraft paper conforming to UU-P-268.
c. Tape conforming to PPP-T-45.
d. Fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, Class Domestic.
e. Index cards conforming to UU-C-128.
f. Plastic material which will include polyethylene and molded polystyrene commonly used as mailing containers (Note: Pressure-sensitive adhesives on polyethylene only functions in the range of 25% to 90% RH at 55°F to 90°F, respectively.)
g. Bare metal surfaces which will include steel, aluminum, and copper. These surfaces will be wiped free of all solvents, oils, and foreign material.
h. Paint surfaces, which will include enamel, acrylic, and epoxy paint.

Immediately after application to the material listed above, the initial adhesion of the tape shall be sufficient to prevent curling of the edges of the tape. One hour after application of the Type I tape and twenty four hours after application of the Type II tape, the tape strips shall be impossible to detach without removing the surface of the material or without delaminating the strip. After the tape is applied, the material will be returned to the test chamber for the period of the test.

4.4.3 Ink penetration. Ink penetration of the printing side of the tape shall be determined by the following test: a medium heavy meter imprint is made on the sample tape, using fluorescent postage meter ink, and a stop watch is started. The sample tape is immediately placed on a flat surface and covered with 32 pound Type III or 40 lb. Type IV bond paper in accordance with Fed. Spec. UU-P-121. A 2 ounce weight with a 1 x 1 inch contact area is placed on top of this. No smudging of the print is permissible after 50 seconds, when the bond paper and weight are pulled over the print.

4.5 Usage. Imprint of Type II tape shows more than 0.10 variation as specified in 3.5.4.3.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Type I. Six (6) rolls of tape of the same class shall be packaged in accordance with PPP-T-681, Level A.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.2 Type II. Each roll shall be packaged in accordance with PPP-T-680, Level A.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Type I. Twelve (12) packages (72 rolls) shall be packed in accordance with PPP-T-681, Level B.

5.2.2 Type II. Twenty four (24) packaged rolls shall be packed in accordance with PPP-T-680, Level B.

5.3 Marking. In addition to the lot or control number and date of pack, and any special marking required in the procurement documents, marking of the interior packages and exterior shipping container shall be in accordance with PPP-T-680 or PPP-T-681, as applicable.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Type I. The gummed tapes covered by this specification are intended for use in Government owned or leased postage meters. National stock number and postage meter bases applicable to these tapes are as follows:

Type I	Item	NSN	Postage Meter Bases
Class 1	29-C	7530-00-912-3924	Singer/Friden 9010 Pitney Bowes 4000 and 5600 Series
Class 2	29-D	7530-00-912-3925	Pitney Bowes 5400 Series

6.1.2 Type II. The pressure sensitive tape covered by this specification is intended for use in Government owned or leased Pitney Bowes, 5800 Series, postage meter bases.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Type and, when applicable, class required (see 1.2).
c. Level of packaging and packing when other than Level C of PPP-T-681 is required (see Section 5).

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

U.S. Postal Service - POS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

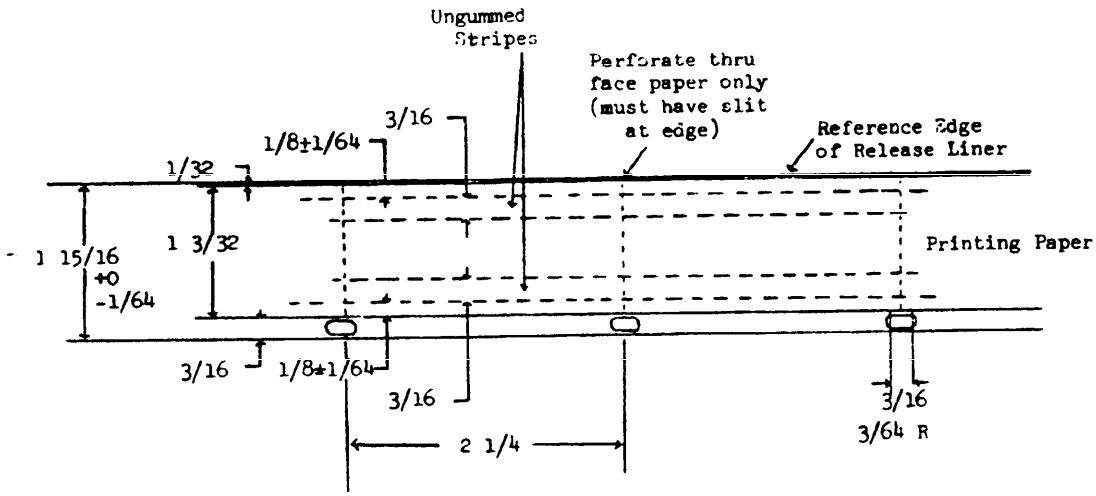
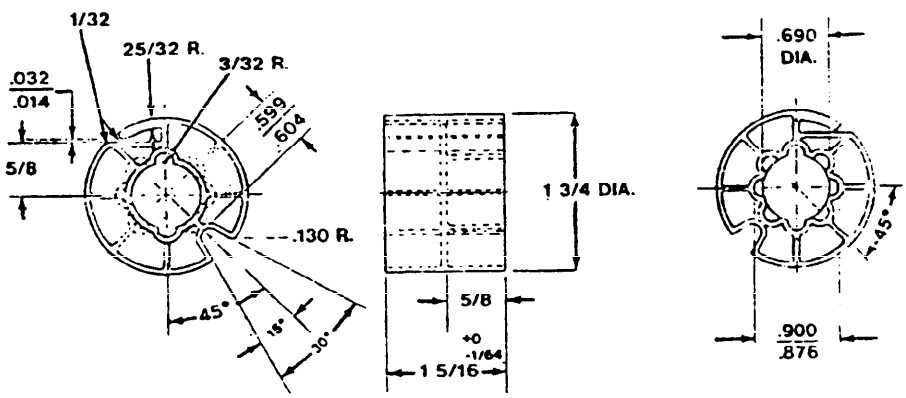


FIGURE 1



NOTES:
1. All walls 3/64 unless otherwise noted.
2. All fillets & radii .010/.020 unless otherwise noted.

FIGURE 2

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 35 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.